

Reframing Matrix

View a problem through four professional lenses

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Reframing Matrix examines a single problem from four different perspectives — classically the '4 Ps': **Product**, **Planning**, **Potential** and **People**, or the distinct professional viewpoints of, say, a marketer, engineer, financier and customer. Each frame surfaces options the default frame hides.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Attributed to management writer Michael Morgan in *Creating Workforce Innovation* (1993).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

People become locked in one professional framing of a problem. Deliberately rotating through other lenses breaks fixation and widens the solution space.

HOW IT IS USED

Draw a grid with the problem in the centre and four surrounding frames. Generate ideas from each frame in turn, then compare the different problem definitions they imply.

WHEN IT IS USED

Problem-reformulation stage, when a team suspects it is solving the obvious rather than the right problem.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Cross-functional teams, strategists and facilitators.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO PRIOR PRACTICE

It operationalises **reframing** — Wedell-Wedellsborg's central idea — as a concrete grid, making perspective-shifting a repeatable step rather than an accident of insight.

FIGURE 1 · FOUR LENSES ON ONE PROBLEM



Figure 1. The '4 Ps' reframing matrix — each lens asks a different question of the same problem.

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SOURCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

Morgan, M. (1993) *Creating Workforce Innovation*. Sydney: Business & Professional Publishing.

Wedell-Wedellsborg, T. (2017) 'Are You Solving the Right Problems?', *Harvard Business Review*, 95(1), pp. 76–83.